Why I Started Shaving My Head at 16

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 23, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/zYd_hMq3OCs Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter shaved his head at 16 upon realizing he'd go bald, reframing the experience by adopting iconic bald men as role models — so that when hair loss actually came, it was a non-event.

📑 Contents

- ⚒️ Proactive Decision to Go Bald at 16
- 🏆 Iconic Bald Role Models
- 💪 The Mindset Takeaway

⚒️ Proactive Decision to Go Bald at 16 0:00

- Recognized early that he was going to lose his hair and decided to get ahead of it
  - Rather than waiting for hair loss to happen to him, he shaved his head himself at age 16
- Consciously rejected two common negative reactions to hair loss:
  - Feeling sorry for himself
  - Becoming paranoid about it
- Instead, he chose to **embrace** baldness before it was even fully underway
  - The result: when his hair actually started going, he "didn't even notice"

🏆 Iconic Bald Role Models 0:00

- Reframed baldness by observing that many widely admired, high-status men are bald
- His personal list of bald role models:
  - Michael Jordan
  - The Rock (Dwayne Johnson)
  - Tupac
  - Mike Tyson
  - Floyd "Money" Mayweather
  - Pitbull
  - Vin Diesel
  - Sean Connery
  - Rick Ross

    - Jeff Bezos
    - Stone Cold Steve Austin
- Used these men as proof that baldness is not a barrier to being cool, successful, or respected

💪 The Mindset Takeaway 0:22

- Core message: hair loss does not have to be a source of insecurity

> "You don't have to let losing your hair or being bald give you a reason to be insecure."

- The strategy is **preemptive acceptance** — adopt the identity before circumstance forces it on you, so the transition carries no emotional weight
- Framing matters: the same physical reality (baldness) can be a weakness or a badge of cool depending entirely on the mental model you attach to it